The Selling closure

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Abstract

A lattice with a right angle has several Selling-reduced cells; Kurlin (2026) showed that there are at most sixteen. This paper treats the set of all of them, with the integer changes of basis between them, as one object, the Selling closure. The closure contains every lattice symmetry and every operator between alternative reduced cells. Symmetries relate only cells of identical shape, and in the lattice types with right angles most of the point group is not visible in any single reduced cell: none of the three twofolds of a primitive orthorhombic lattice relabels its reduced cell. The members and operators of the closure are fixed by which conorms vanish, and which operators are symmetries by which are equal, so the closure with its symmetries marked is one object per Delone sort, and the 24 sorts are reproduced from the six possible patterns of vanishing conorms; the classical lattice conditions, $c/a = \sqrt{2}$, $b = \sqrt{3}\,a$, $a = c$ in a monoclinic cell, are the single linear conditions on conorms under which one closure becomes another, the monoclinic ones one per cell choice. For measured cells, near-congruence within a conorm band τ is defined and shown to be decided

by a widened closure, Selling reduction with its boundary moved to $-\tau$. The widened closure is unique, is the union of the exact closures of all lattices within the band, and is computed completely by setting every conorm below 4τ to zero, enumerating the exact closure there, and filtering with the measured metric; walks from the measured cell miss members. From a single reduced cell of a new cell the reindexing operator onto a reference is then found, with a stated guarantee.

1. Introduction

Two questions recur in indexing and data processing. What are the symmetries of a lattice? And are two cells the same lattice, and if so by which integer matrix? Both are usually answered by searching: for symmetry, a scan for near-twofolds within an angular tolerance (Le Page, 1982); for reindexing, a list of small integer matrices, or the operators of the point group just found. The symmetry search is complete within its index bound; the reindexing search is complete only if the list happens to contain the operator. Both are complicated by the same fact: a lattice with a right angle has more than one reduced cell, and the alternatives are related by integer matrices that are not symmetries.

Selling reduction makes the multiplicity explicit. A lattice on a right angle has several obtuse superbases; Kurlin (2026) proved that there are never more than sixteen and listed them by lattice type. We take the whole set, with the integer matrices between its members, as the object of study and call it the *Selling closure*. The term is introduced here; Kurlin's results concern the set of obtuse superbases.

The paper asks what the closure contains, how it behaves for measured cells, and what that gives for reindexing. Section 2 defines the operators and introduces one monoclinic cell that is used throughout. Section 3 describes the computations. Section 4 gives the results: the structure of the closure and its dependence on the Delone

sort; near-congruence of measured cells within a band and its complete computation; and reindexing from a single reduced cell. The relation to earlier work is set out in Section 5. Proofs are in Appendix A, the conversion of a measurement error into a band in Appendix B, and every number in the text carries a mark [z*nn*] naming the computational check that reproduces it (Appendix C).

2. The Selling closure

2.1. Superbases, conorms and the metric tensor

Selling reduction works with four vectors rather than three: the cell vectors a, b, c and $d = -a - b - c$. The four form a *superbase*; any three of them are a basis of the lattice. The six negated pair products

$$p_{ab} = -a \cdot b, \quad p_{ac} = -a \cdot c, \quad p_{bc} = -b \cdot c, \quad p_{ad} = -a \cdot d, \quad p_{bd} = -b \cdot d, \quad p_{cd} = -c \cdot d$$

are the *conorms* (Selling, 1874; Conway & Sloane, 1992). The Selling parameters of the S^6 formalism (Andrews *et al.*, 2019) are the same six numbers with the opposite sign, listed in the order $b \cdot c$, $a \cdot c$, $a \cdot b$, $a \cdot d$, $b \cdot d$, $c \cdot d$; that order is used for the sort patterns of Table 4, and the order da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc elsewhere. A superbase is *obtuse*, which is to say Selling-reduced, when all six conorms are non-negative. The metric tensor in the basis (a, b, c) is linear in the conorms,

$$\mathbf{G} = \begin{pmatrix} p_{ab} + p_{ac} + p_{ad} & -p_{ab} & -p_{ac} \\ -p_{ab} & p_{ab} + p_{bc} + p_{bd} & -p_{bc} \\ -p_{ac} & -p_{bc} & p_{ac} + p_{bc} + p_{cd} \end{pmatrix}, \tag{1}$$

so the conorms are an alternative set of six cell parameters, and a change to the conorms is a change to the cell with nothing to reconstruct. A conorm that is exactly zero is a right angle between two of the four vectors; this paper calls a zero conorm a *wall*, after the boundary it forms in the space of cells, and the set of slots that vanish the *zero pattern* of the cell. Only six zero patterns are possible if the four vectors are

to remain connected by non-zero conorms: no zero; one; two sharing a vector; two disjoint; three forming a triangle; three forming a path.

2.2. The Selling operators

Two kinds of integer operator act on a superbase, and every operator in this paper is a product of them.

Flips. A flip at the conorm p_{ab} replaces a by $-a$ and adds the old a to the two other vectors: $(a, b, c, d) \mapsto (-a,\ b,\ c+a,\ d+a)$. It changes the sign of p_{ab}. Selling reduction applies flips at negative conorms until none remain; the sum of the conorms decreases at each step, so it stops, at an obtuse superbase. A flip at a conorm that is exactly zero carries one obtuse superbase to another obtuse superbase of the same lattice, which is why the reduced cell of a lattice with a right angle is not unique. With the basis (a, b, c) each of the six flips is a fixed 3×3 integer matrix of determinant -1 that is its own inverse (Table 1). The flips are the boundary transformations of Andrews *et al.* (2019), written on the basis rather than on the six Selling parameters.

Table 1. *The six Selling flips as* 3×3 *integer matrices in the basis* (a, b, c), $d = -a - b - c$; *columns are the new basis vectors in the old basis. Each has determinant* -1 *and squares to the identity. The second column gives the flip as a setting change in the notation of crystallographic software.*

flip at	new basis	matrix
$a \cdot b$	$(-a,\ b,\ a + c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$a \cdot c$	$(-a,\ a + b,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$b \cdot c$	$(a + b,\ -b,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$a \cdot d$	$(a,\ -a - c,\ -a - b)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$
$b \cdot d$	$(-b - c,\ b,\ -a - b)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$
$c \cdot d$	$(-b - c,\ -a - c,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

Swaps. A superbase is an unordered set of four vectors up to a common sign, so one reduced cell can be written in $4! \times 2 = 48$ ways. The 48 reorderings and sign changes are the swaps. They change which three vectors are called a, b, c and in which order, and nothing else.

Products, and symmetries among them. A sequence of flips at zero conorms followed by a swap carries a reduced cell to a reduced cell of the same lattice, possibly one of different shape, and every integer matrix that carries a reduced cell to a reduced cell is such a product (Kurlin, 2026; Lemma A5). A lattice symmetry is an integer matrix g with $g^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{G}g = \mathbf{G}$; it carries reduced cells to reduced cells, so it is one of these products. Which products are symmetries depends on the conorm values, not on the operators: a product is a symmetry for exactly those lattices whose conorms it leaves unchanged. The twofold rotations are the symmetries that matter in practice: together with the inversion they generate the point group of any lattice, which is the basis of the Le Page (1982) search and is used in the same way by Lebedev *et al.* (2006).

2.3. The closure, and one cell used throughout

The *Selling closure* $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{G})$ of a lattice is the set of all its obtuse superbases, each counted once up to swaps, together with the products of flips and swaps between them. Kurlin (2026) proved that the set has 1, 2, 3, 6 or 16 members according to the pattern of zero conorms and that flips at zero conorms reach all of them. The members, as integer combinations of the reduced cell vectors, and the operators between them are the same for every lattice with the same zero pattern (Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5, which list them); only the conorm values differ.

Take $a = 30$, $b = 40$, $c = 50$ Å, $\beta = 100°$. Its reduced superbase is $M_0 = (d, a, b, c)$ with conorms

$$p_{ab} = 0, \quad p_{bc} = 0, \quad p_{ac} = 260.5, \quad p_{ad} = 639.5, \quad p_{bd} = 1600.0, \quad p_{cd} = 2239.5 \text{ Å}^2.$$

The two walls are the right angles α and γ at the twofold axis b, present in every primitive monoclinic lattice. No other conorm is small, so the lattice is not near a higher symmetry.[z46] The closure has six members (Table 2); each has two walls, each flip leads to a neighbour, and the six form a ring M_0–M_1–M_5–M_4–M_3–M_2–M_0. All six carry the same six conorm values in different positions, and in its own basis each is, in general, a differently shaped cell.

Table 2. *The Selling closure of the monoclinic cell $a = 30$, $b = 40$, $c = 50$ Å, $\beta = 100°$: six obtuse superbases, each up to the order and common sign of its vectors, and the flips at zero conorms that connect them.*

member	four vectors	zero-conorm flips lead to
M_0	$-a-b-c,\ a,\ b,\ c$	M_1, M_2
M_1	$-b-c,\ -a,\ b,\ a+c$	M_0, M_5
M_2	$-a-c,\ a+b,\ -b,\ c$	M_0, M_3
M_3	$a+c,\ b-c,\ -b,\ -a$	M_2, M_4
M_4	$a-b+c,\ -c,\ b,\ -a$	M_3, M_5
M_5	$a-b,\ c,\ b,\ -a-c$	M_1, M_4

The point group is $2/m$. Each of its four operations carries M_0 to a member (Table 3).[z46] The identity and the inversion carry M_0 to itself: they are swaps

of M_0, and visible in it. The twofold sends $(a, b, c) \mapsto (-a, b, -c)$ and so carries $(-a - b - c, a, b, c)$ to $(a - b + c, -a, b, -c)$, which is not a reordering of M_0 but the member M_4, three flips away; the mirror does the same. Read in the twofold's order, $(-a, b, -c)$, the basis of M_4 has the metric tensor of (a, b, c); read in the order of Table 2, $(-c, b, -a)$, it has a different one, with 639.5 and 2239.5 exchanged.[z46] In the operators of Section 2.2, the twofold is the flips $a \cdot b$, $b \cdot c$, $d \cdot b$ — the path $M_0 \to M_1 \to M_5 \to M_4$ — followed by the swap $-(a, c, b, d)$, and the mirror the same flips with the swap (a, c, b, d); a swap is written by listing which vectors of the member, in the member's own labelling, become the new d, a, b, c, with a leading sign for the common sign change.[z46] Half of the point group is therefore not visible in the reduced cell: it consists of operators between reduced cells. "Visible" means only that the operation reorders the reduced superbase; a search over lattice vectors, as Le Page's, finds the twofold either way, since it tests directions rather than relabellings.

Table 3. *The four symmetries of the monoclinic lattice of Table 2, applied to the reduced cell M_0. Matrices act on coordinates in the basis a, b, c.*

symmetry	matrix	M_0 is carried to	visible in M_0
1	diag(1, 1, 1)	M_0	yes, a swap of M_0
$\bar{1}$	diag(−1, −1, −1)	M_0	yes, a swap of M_0
2 along b	diag(−1, 1, −1)	M_4	no
m normal to b	diag(1, −1, 1)	M_4	no

2.4. Delone sorts

Delone (1933) classified lattices into 24 sorts by the pattern of zeros and equalities among the reduced Selling parameters, each sort lying in one Bravais type and some Bravais types comprising several sorts; the 24 patterns, with the symbols C1 to A3 used below, are listed by Andrews *et al.* (2023). The sorts are the Selling counterpart of the 44 Niggli lattice characters: they split a Bravais type by the shape of the cell, not by its symmetry. Since the closure's structure depends only on the zero pattern and its symmetries on the equalities, the sort is the natural unit for describing closures.

2.5. Measured cells

A measured cell is never exactly on a wall: a right angle is measured as 90.25° and the conorm is a small number of either sign. The band τ, in Å^2, is the tolerance within which a conorm counts as zero; Appendix B says how a declared error on the metric tensor is converted into τ, and the worked measured cell below has $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ for a metric error of $14.4\,\text{Å}^2$, a band chosen large enough to show the filter at work and, as noted in Section 4.3, beyond the range in which Theorem 2 applies to that cell. The *widened closure* of a metric at band τ is

$$\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{\, F \;:\; \text{all six conorms of } F \text{ under } \mathbf{G} \text{ are } \geq -\tau \,\}, \tag{2}$$

the superbases that Selling reduction would accept with its boundary moved from 0 to $-\tau$. The *depth* of a superbase is the size of its most negative conorm, so it belongs to the widened closure when its depth is at most τ, and its depth is the band at which it enters. Two cells are τ-*congruent* when some reduced superbase of one, carried by an integer operator $\mathbf{P}$ onto the other, has each of its six conorms agreeing to within τ under the two metrics; exact congruence, $\mathbf{P}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{G}\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{G}'$, is the case $\tau = 0$. Finally, λ_1 denotes the squared length of the shortest lattice vector, and the *price* of an operator $\mathbf{P}$ between two metrics is the residual $\|\mathbf{P}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{G}\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{G}'\|_F$; with $\mathbf{G}' = \mathbf{G}$ it is the amount by which $\mathbf{P}$ fails to be a symmetry.

3. Methods

3.1. Closures and symmetries by sort

For each of the 24 sorts a generic lattice was built from its pattern with random values for the free parameters. Its closure was enumerated by flips at the exact zeros from the reduced superbase, and its symmetries found by testing every member, in every order and sign of its four vectors, against the metric tensor. Symmetries car-

rying the reduced superbase to itself were counted separately from those carrying it elsewhere. Members were grouped into shapes — the same conorm vector up to swaps — and into orbits under the symmetries.

3.2. Reproducing the sorts

For each of the six zero patterns a generic lattice was built and its closure enumerated. Each member, in each order of its vectors, rearranges the six conorm values; the rearrangements that keep the zeros in place form a finite set of permutations. A pattern of equal conorms was accepted as a sort when imposing it on a generic lattice produced a lattice whose symmetries enforce exactly those equalities and no others, and patterns that describe the same lattices from different members were counted once. No Bravais types or point groups were supplied.

3.3. Specialisations between sorts

The conorms of any member of a closure, in any labelling, are integer combinations of the reduced cell's conorms, hence linear in the free parameters of the sort (the letters of Table 4). Imposing another sort's pattern — its zeros and its equalities — on one member is a homogeneous linear system in those parameters. For every sort, every member and labelling, and every other sort, the system was solved; a solution with the parameters non-negative, a non-singular lattice, and a resulting lattice that is of the target sort and no higher, is a specialisation, recorded with the member's shape. The conditions of codimension one, a single linear relation, were collected.

3.4. Measured cells: idealise, enumerate, filter

The widened closure of equation (2) is computed as follows.

1. Selling-reduce the measured cell to a superbase F_0.

2. Set every conorm of F_0 that is at most 4τ to zero, all at once, and form the metric tensor $\mathbf{G}^*$ of the result by equation (1). This is the *idealised lattice* Λ^*; it has an exact zero pattern.

3. Enumerate the exact closure of Λ^* by flips at its zeros, keeping each member as integer combinations of F_0 — equivalently, keeping the operators $\mathbf{W}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{W}_m$ from F_0 to each member.

4. Evaluate each member with the *measured* metric tensor and keep those whose six conorms are all at least $-\tau$. Record each member's depth.

The operators of step 3 are integer matrices independent of the metric, so they are the same for Λ^* and for the measured cell; the measured metric enters only in step 4. Section 4.3 proves that this returns exactly $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$.

3.5. Reindexing from one reduced cell

A reference R is stored as its widened closure in integer coordinates. Centred cells are first taken to a primitive cell, and the centring matrices are composed with the operator found. The band is set from the metric error η: the worked examples use $\tau = 3\eta$, which covers every member of the stored closure in the frames that occur there but is not a worst-case guarantee (Appendix B); a cell with estimated standard deviations has a covariance for its metric tensor, and the band can then be set slot by slot as in Appendix B. A new cell N is reduced once; its reduced superbase paired with each stored member, in each order and sign, gives a candidate operator $\mathbf{P}$ with $\mathbf{G}_N \approx \mathbf{P}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{G}_R\mathbf{P}$, ranked by its price in R's frame.

3.6. Verification

Closure memberships were checked against brute force: every basis with coordinates in $[-2, 2]$ relative to F_0 (135 408 bases of determinant ± 1), completed to a superbase

by its fourth vector, tested against equation (2). The fourth vector is where the entries of 3 mentioned in Appendix B occur, so the window contains every member found in any check. Symmetry counts and sort derivations were exhaustive. Test lattices were specified by their conorms. The measured worked cell is 30.02, 39.97, 50.03 Å, 90.25°, 92.05°, 89.80°: the cell 30–40–50 Å, $\beta = 92°$, which sits on two walls, perturbed by 14.4 Å^2 in the Frobenius norm of its metric tensor. The checks are the test files of Appendix C.

4. Results

4.1. What the closure contains

Table 4 gives the closure of each sort. Out of each member there are exactly as many symmetry operators as the point group has elements, and in every sort that number is the order of the holohedry: 48, 24, 16, 12, 8, 4 or 2.[z46] The twofolds, with the inversion, generate the group in every sort, so finding the twofolds suffices.[z46]

Table 4. *The Selling closure of each Delone sort, for a generic lattice of the pattern. Patterns are Selling parameters in the* S^6 *order* $b\cdot c, a\cdot c, a\cdot b, a\cdot d, b\cdot d, c\cdot d$*; equal letters denote equal values and* 0 *a zero. Members are counted up to swaps. "Visible" is the number of symmetries that carry the reduced superbase to itself; the rest carry it to another member. "Shapes" is the number of distinct cell shapes among the members, equal in every case to the number of orbits of members under the symmetries. "Visible" depends on which member one reduces to; values are for the pattern as written.*

sort	Bravais	pattern	zeros	members	|group|	visible	shapes
C1	cI	rrrrrr	0	1	48	48	1
C3	cF	rr0rr0	2	3	48	16	1
C5	cP	000rrr	3	16	48	12	2
H4	hP	00rrrs	2	6	24	4	1
T1	tI	rrsrrs	0	1	16	16	1
T2	tI	rr0rrs	1	2	16	8	1
T5	tP	000rrs	3	16	16	4	3
R1	hR	rrrsss	0	1	12	12	1
R3	hR	rr0sr0	2	3	12	4	1
O1A	oF	rrsrrt	0	1	8	8	1
O1B	oI	rstrst	0	1	8	8	1
O2	oI	rs0srt	1	2	8	4	1
O3	oI	rs0rs0	2	3	8	8	2
O4	oS	00rsst	2	6	8	4	2
O5	oP	000rst	3	16	8	2	4
M1A	mC	rrsttu	0	1	4	4	1
M1B	mC	rstrsu	0	1	4	4	1
M2A	mC	rs0stu	1	2	4	2	1
M2B	mC	rs0rst	1	2	4	4	2
M3	mC	rs0ts0	2	3	4	4	2
M4	mP	00rstu	2	6	4	2	3
A1	aP	rstuvw	0	1	2	2	1
A2	aP	rs0tuv	1	2	2	2	2
A3	aP	rs0tu0	2	3	2	2	3

Zero pattern and sort fix different parts. Which members exist and which operators join them is fixed by the zero pattern; which of the operators are symmetries is fixed by the sort, and the abstract group by the Bravais type. Primitive monoclinic, C-centred orthorhombic and primitive hexagonal lattices all have two zeros and six members and differ only in how many operators are symmetries (4, 8, 24). Body-centred tetragonal lattices have no zero below $c/a = \sqrt{2}$ and one zero above it, and C-centred monoclinic lattices occupy five sorts with three zero patterns, depending on the cell shape; the sort boundary is where a symmetry-forced right angle enters or leaves the reduced cell, with no change of symmetry. Within one sort the shape plays no part: the members, the operators and the symmetries are the same, and the lattice supplies only the

numbers attached to them.

Symmetry visible in one cell. In the sorts with walls the symmetries that relabel the reduced cell are a minority: 2 of 8 for primitive orthorhombic, 4 of 16 for primitive tetragonal, 12 of 48 for primitive cubic, 4 of 24 for hexagonal, 4 of 12 for rhombohedral R3.[z46] For the twofolds alone: none of the three twofolds of a primitive orthorhombic lattice relabels its reduced cell, nor the one twofold of primitive monoclinic; of the five, nine and seven of primitive tetragonal, cubic and hexagonal, one, three and one do.[z46] The rest are short flip words to other members.

Cell shapes. Out of M_0 in the monoclinic example there are $48 \times 6 = 288$ operators, one to each labelling of each member; four are symmetries; of the other 284, 92 lead to M_4 or to M_0 itself in other labellings, the same shape, and 192 to the two other shapes. In every sort two members are related by a symmetry exactly when they have the same shape, so the number of shapes equals the number of symmetry orbits (last column of Table 4), and no symmetry ever relates cells of different shape.[z46] The monoclinic cell has three shapes: $\{M_0, M_4\}$ is 30, 40, 50 Å, $\beta = 100°$; $\{M_1, M_3\}$ is 30, 40, 53.7 Å, $\beta = 113.4°$, the alternative choice $a + c$; $\{M_2, M_5\}$ is a third.[z46] Two measurements that reduce to M_0 and to M_1 report different cell parameters and are related by no symmetry, only by the flip at $a \cdot b$. Ten of the 24 sorts have more than one shape; primitive orthorhombic has four.

Alternative settings are shapes. Table 6 lists the shapes of the ten sorts that have more than one, each written as the cell with the most right angles and no acute angle.[z49] Every shape is a legitimate cell of the same lattice, and every extra shape looks like a conventional cell of some class. The three shapes of a primitive monoclinic lattice are the three cells on $\{a, c, a+c\}$ with b unique: the three cell choices of *International Tables* and the familiar c versus $a + c$ ambiguity, here with the third choice alongside. The three extra shapes of a primitive orthorhombic lattice are monoclinic-

looking cells with two right angles, one for each axis that is traded for a face diagonal: 30, 40, 62.6 Å, $\beta = 118.6°$ is (a, b, $a+c$), and the same shape also contains (a, b, $b+c$), 30, 40, 68.0 Å, $\alpha = 126°$; primitive tetragonal has two such and primitive cubic one. C-centred orthorhombic has two primitive shapes, and the boundary sorts of body-centred orthorhombic, C-centred monoclinic and triclinic, where the reduced cell is on a wall with no symmetry behind it, have two or three cells with a single right angle each — for triclinic, the known instability of the reduced cell when an angle is near 90°. Since no symmetry connects two shapes, no symmetry-based procedure converts one into another; the flips do, and the closure holds all of them.

The classical cell conditions fall out. Table 5 lists every way in which a lattice of one sort becomes a lattice of another under a single linear condition on its parameters (Section 3.3): 37 conditions, 36 pairs of sorts.[z50] Every condition is of one of two kinds, a parameter vanishing (a new right angle in some member) or two parameters becoming equal (two conorms of some member equal). The familiar lattice conditions are among them with their classical values: body-centred tetragonal is face-centred cubic at $c/a = \sqrt{2}$ and body-centred cubic at $c/a = 1$; C-centred orthorhombic is hexagonal at $b = \sqrt{3}\,a$ and tetragonal at $b = a$; rhombohedral is cubic at $\alpha = 60°$, 90° and 109.47°; primitive monoclinic is C-centred orthorhombic when $a = c$. What the table adds is the role of the shapes. The monoclinic conditions come in threes and each is carried by a different shape: with unique axis c and plane lattice a, b, the lattice is C-centred orthorhombic when $|a| = |b|$, or $|a| = |a + b|$, or $|b| = |a + b|$, and primitive orthorhombic when $a \perp b$, $a \perp (a + b)$ or $b \perp (a + b)$ — the one condition $a = c$ of the textbooks, read in each of the three cell choices. A program that holds one cell choice sees one of the three; the other two are the same lattice condition on a cell it did not report. The table also shows which sorts sit one condition away from a much higher symmetry: a C-centred monoclinic lattice is tetragonal, body-centred

tetragonal or rhombohedral after one equality, a body-centred orthorhombic lattice on its boundary sort is face-centred cubic after one, and a triclinic lattice on a wall is C-centred monoclinic after one. Those are the lattices whose reduced cell, measured with error, lies within a band of a pattern with many more symmetries, and whose idealised closure therefore offers the most pseudo-symmetric alternatives.

Table 5. *All specialisations of codimension one between the 24 sorts. Conditions are on the letters of the sort's pattern in Table 4; "shapes" is the number of distinct cell shapes of the starting sort through which the conditions are reached, and the last column reads the condition in the cell of the conventional description where that is short.*[z50]

from	to	conditions	shapes	reading
aP A1	aP A2	any letter $= 0$	1	a right angle appears
aP A2	aP A3	$v = 0$	1	a second right angle
aP A2	mC M2A	$s = t$, $r = u$	1	
aP A2	mP M4	r, s, t or $u = 0$	1	
aP A3	mC M3	any two letters equal	3	one per shape
mP M4	oP O5	$r = 0$, $s = 0$, $t = 0$	3	$a \perp b$, $a \perp (a + b)$, $b \perp (a + b)$
mP M4	oS O4	$s = t$, $r = t$, $r = s$	3	$\|a\| = \|b\|$, $\|a\| = \|a+b\|$, $\|b\| = \|a+b\|$
mC M1A	oF O1A	$r = t$	1	
mC M1A	oI O2	$u = 0$	1	
mC M1A	oS O4	$r = 0$, $t = 0$	1	
mC M1B	mC M2B	$t = 0$, $u = 0$	1	boundary sort
mC M1B	mC M3	$r = 0$, $s = 0$	1	boundary sort
mC M1B	oF O1A	$r = s$	1	
mC M1B	oI O1B	$t = u$	1	
mC M2A	oI O2	$r = t$	1	
mC M2B	oI O3	$t = 0$	1	
mC M2B	tI T2	$r = s$	1	one step to tI
mC M2B	tP T5	$r = 0$, $s = 0$	1	one step to tP
mC M3	oI O3	$r = t$	1	
mC M3	hR R3	$r = s$, $s = t$	1	one step to hR
oP O5	tP T5	$r = s$, $r = t$, $s = t$	1	$a = b$, $a = c$, $b = c$
oS O4	tP T5	$r = 0$	1	$b = a$
oS O4	hP H4	$r = s$	1	$b = \sqrt{3}\,a$
oI O1B	oI O3	r, s or $t = 0$	1	boundary sort
oI O1B	tI T1	$r = s$, $r = t$, $s = t$	1	two edges equal
oI O2	tI T2	$r = s$	1	
oI O3	cF C3	$r = s$	1	one step to cF
oF O1A	tI T1	$s = t$	1	
oF O1A	tI T2	$s = 0$, $t = 0$	1	
tP T5	cP C5	$r = s$	1	$c = a$
tI T1	cI C1	$r = s$	1	$c/a = 1$
tI T1	cF C3	$s = 0$	1	$c/a = \sqrt{2}$ from below
tI T2	cF C3	$s = 0$	1	$c/a = \sqrt{2}$ from above
hR R1	cP C5	$r = 0$	1	$\alpha = 90°$
hR R1	cI C1	$r = s$	1	$\alpha = 109.47°$
hR R3	cF C3	$r = s$	1	$\alpha = 60°$

Table 6. *The cell shapes of the sorts with more than one, for the cells named; each shape is given as the cell with the most right angles and all angles* $\geq 90°$*, shortest edges first when several qualify and b unique for the monoclinic-looking ones, with the number n of members (up to swaps) that have it. Centred cells are given by their primitive cells; the boundary sorts are specified by Selling parameters in the* S^6 *order of Table 4, in* $Å^2$*.*[z49]

sort	lattice	n	shape
cP	30 Å	4	30, 30, 30; 90, 90, 90
		12	30, 30, 42.4; 90, 135, 90
tP	30, 30, 50 Å	4	30, 30, 50; 90, 90, 90
		4	30, 30, 58.3; 90, 121.0, 90
		8	30, 50, 42.4; 90, 135, 90
oP	30, 40, 55 Å	4	30, 40, 55; 90, 90, 90
		4	30, 40, 62.6; 90, 118.6, 90
		4	30, 55, 50; 90, 126.9, 90
		4	40, 55, 50; 90, 143.1, 90
oS	C 30, 40, 50 Å	2	25, 50, 25; 90, 106.3, 90
		4	25, 50, 30; 90, 126.9, 90
mP	30, 40, 50 Å, 100°	2	30, 40, 50; 90, 100, 90
		2	30, 40, 53.7; 90, 113.4, 90
		2	50, 40, 53.7; 90, 146.6, 90
oI (O3)	900, 1600, 0, 900, 1600, 0	1	50, 50, 50; 111.1, 129.8, 90
		2	42.4, 50, 50; 90, 115.1, 115.1
mC (M2B)	900, 1600, 0, 900, 1600, 2500	1	50, 50, 70.7; 104.7, 116.9, 90
		1	50, 50, 65.6; 105.9, 105.9, 90
mC (M3)	900, 1600, 0, 2500, 1600, 0	1	50, 50, 64.0; 120, 90, 111.1
		2	50, 56.6, 58.3; 90, 108.0, 124.4
aP (A2)	900, 1600, 0, 2500, 400, 1200	1	36.1, 60.8, 64.0; 114.3, 90, 114.2
		1	36.1, 56.6, 64.0; 116.2, 90, 101.3
aP (A3)	900, 1600, 0, 2500, 400, 0	1	36.1, 50, 53.9; 90, 101.9, 119.9
		1	44.7, 50, 53.9; 90, 99.6, 135.7
		1	36.1, 44.7, 58.3; 90, 115.3, 104.4

4.2. The 24 sorts reproduced

The procedure of Section 3.2, starting from six zero patterns, returns exactly 24 patterns of equal conorms, and they are Delone's, as listed by Andrews *et al.* (2023), none missing and none extra.[z48] The point groups, not supplied, come out as the holohedries, and the member counts as Kurlin's 1, 2, 3, 6 and 16.[z48] The three patterns that Andrews *et al.* describe as degenerate boundaries (O3, M2B, M3), which lie on the boundary between two other sorts of the same Bravais type, arise like the others. This confirms Delone's classification from the closure alone and gives it an operational reading: a sort is a pattern of zeros and equalities such that a lattice with that pattern

has exactly the symmetries the pattern implies.

4.3. Near-congruence within a band

The measured problem. For the measured monoclinic cell with $\alpha = 90.25°$, the conorms p_{ab} and p_{bc} are small numbers of either sign. The flips that gave M_1 and M_2 now give superbases with a slightly negative conorm, Selling reduction rejects them, and the exact closure has one member instead of six; the twofold and the mirror, which were operators to M_4, now lead to a cell that is not in the set.

What the widened closure is. Equation (2) names no starting cell, order of operations or frame, so $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$ is the same whoever computes it. By Proposition 1 (Appendix A) a superbase belongs to it exactly when it is the exactly reduced superbase of some lattice within τ of $\mathbf{G}$ in that superbase's own conorms: the widened closure is the union of the exact closures of all lattices consistent with the measurement. The cell at which reduction with a $-\tau$ boundary stops is not well defined: from 400 random starting bases, reduction of the measured worked cell at $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ stopped at six different cells and of a noisy orthorhombic cell at sixteen, every one a member of $\mathcal{S}_\tau$, but on a noisy cubic cell at $\tau = 10\,\text{Å}^2$ the 400 restarts found 15 of the 16 members.[z45] The set has to be computed, not sampled.

Near-congruence is decided by the widened closure. If two cells are τ-congruent through a superbase F reduced for the new cell, then F, carried to the reference, has all conorms at least $-\tau$ and so lies in the reference's widened closure. Near-congruence is therefore decided without a search over operators: compute $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}_R)$ once, reduce the new cell once, and pair its reduced superbase with each stored member. The stored set contains the connecting cell whenever one exists.

The computation is complete. If $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$, the four steps of Section 3.4 return exactly $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$ (Theorem 2 and Corollary 2a, Appendix A): every superbase within the band

is an exact member of the idealised lattice, so enumerating the idealised closure and filtering cannot miss it. On every test lattice and band, including walls placed between τ and 4τ, the procedure returned the brute-force set.[z44] The condition is sufficient, not sharp: for the measured worked cell it allows τ up to 28.2 Å^2, and the procedure is still exact at 43.2 and 60 Å^2;[z44] for a shortest cell edge of 30 Å it allows bands up to about 28 Å^2, i.e. with $\tau = 3\eta$ a metric error of about 9 Å^2; the worked cell's 14.4 Å^2 is beyond that, so for it the exactness at 43.2 Å^2 is an observation and not an instance of the theorem.

Scale and anisotropy. The condition $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$ is a ratio of two squared lengths, so it does not depend on the size of the cell. For an angular error σ (in radians) the band on a conorm between vectors of lengths $|u_i|$, $|u_j|$ is about $\sigma|u_i||u_j|$, and for a cell with edges all near a the condition reads $\sigma \lesssim 1/32$ rad, about 1.8°, with the same number for a 5 Å and a 300 Å cell. What the condition does respond to is anisotropy. For a needle ($5 \times 5 \times 100$ Å) or a plate ($100 \times 100 \times 5$ Å) one uniform band has to cover the conorms between the long vectors, and 32τ then exceeds the square of the short edge at an angular precision of a few thousandths of a degree. With a band per slot, $\tau_{ij} = \sigma|u_i||u_j|$ — the covariance route of Appendix B — and the same four steps, the needle is recovered: on three needles (primitive monoclinic, orthorhombic and hexagonal; four random errors at each of 0.02°, 0.05°, 0.2° and 0.5°) the procedure returned the brute-force set in every one of the 44 cases in which the idealised lattice existed; in the other four a conorm comparable to λ_1 had been zeroed.[z49] The plate is a genuine floor: its two long vectors meet on a wall whose band $\sigma a_{\mathrm{long}}^2$ is compared with $\lambda_1 = a_{\mathrm{short}}^2$, so the condition fails once σ exceeds $(a_{\mathrm{short}}/a_{\mathrm{long}})^2/32$, which is 0.0045° for the plate above. The procedure was in fact still exact at 0.02° and 0.05°, but at 0.2° and 0.5° the widened closure has 24 and 36 members: it is then not the closure of any one lattice, and the procedure, which returns at most the sixteen members of Λ^*,

misses some.[z49] The failure announces itself before the filter: a conorm of the order of λ_1 has been idealised, so that Λ^* is singular or its λ_1 is below 32 times the largest band on an idealised slot, and the brute-force window of Section 3.6 is the fallback. The per-slot statement is checked, not proved; Theorem 2 is stated for one band. Idealising all small conorms together is required by the proof and loses nothing, since the closure of any partial idealisation lies inside that of the full one (Lemma A6);[z46] the threshold 4τ is what the proof requires, and on dense two-wall grids 2τ was already exact while τ was not.[z46]

Walks from the measured cell miss members. The natural alternative starts from the measured reduced cell and flips across any conorm within some band of zero. Table 7 compares four versions with the procedure above on 80 cells with walls at awkward positions, constructed to be the worst case rather than sampled from a database; all four miss members. The cause is a member reachable only through a non-member: with walls at 1.2τ and 0.5τ, the flip across the first gives a conorm of -1.2τ, outside the band, and only a second flip, across the other wall, reaches a member of depth 0.7τ. On the idealised lattice both walls are zero and both flips cost nothing. Idealising at τ rather than 4τ fails on the same configuration.[z44] The most negative conorm of such a member is the difference of two small conorms; in the configurations checked they appear when one small conorm $z \le \tau$ and another lies between τ and $z+\tau$; they carry no symmetry (a lattice on such a difference-wall has point group $\bar{1}$); and they are ordinary alternative reduced cells to which a second measurement of the lattice can reduce.[z46]

Table 7. *Four walks on the measured metric, and the procedure of Section 3.4, against brute force on 80 cells with walls at awkward positions (orthorhombic, cubic, plate, monoclinic and hexagonal zero patterns; $\tau = 0.1$ and 0.5 of $\lambda_1/32$).*

procedure	cells with a wrong set
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \le \tau$, keep only cells within the band	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \le \tau$, filter at the end	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \le 2\tau$, keep only cells within the band	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \le 2\tau$, filter at the end	2
idealise at 4τ, enumerate the exact closure, filter	0

The idealised lattice is not a symmetry assignment. Setting the small conorms to zero resembles the most generous choice a Le Page search makes, but what comes back is different. Le Page returns a point group, asserted. The idealisation returns the closure of a lattice Λ^*, and asserts nothing: Λ^*'s symmetries are candidates with prices, and the filter removes the members the measurement does not support. Nor is Λ^* in general of higher symmetry. Idealisation imposes zeros but no equalities, so a measured primitive monoclinic cell whose only small conorms are its two symmetry-forced walls idealises to a primitive monoclinic lattice. What Λ^* always has is a zero pattern at least as degenerate as the measured cell's. Only when the small conorms are the walls of a higher class does Λ^* lie in that class, and then its extra symmetries are the pseudo-symmetries, each priced.

A worked filter. Table 8 shows the procedure on the measured worked cell. The reduced superbase has conorms $(49.5, 1588.9, 2444.7, 4.2, 847.5, 4.5)\,\text{Å}^2$ in the slots da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc. At $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ the three conorms below $4\tau = 172.8$ are set to zero and equation (1) gives the idealised lattice: its reduced superbase has edges 29.1, 39.9, 57.4 Å with $\beta = 120.5°$, and it is orthorhombic, with the orthogonal cell $29.1 \times 39.9 \times 49.4\,\text{Å}$ on $(a, b, a + c)$ — the reduced cell of an orthorhombic lattice is one of its monoclinic-looking shapes (Table 6). Its closure has sixteen members; each row gives one as a word in the flips of Table 1 and its six conorms under the *measured* metric, computed from the member's integer coordinates with no further reduction. A member is kept when its smallest conorm is at least $-\tau$; nothing is inherited, and

several kept members have a parent on the walk that is rejected.[z45] The sign of a conorm belongs to the member: $p_{ab} = +4.2$ in F_0, -4.2 after the flip ab, $+4.2$ after flipping back. Deeper members carry integer combinations of the small conorms — $-(49.5 + 4.2)$, $-(49.5 - 4.5)$, $-(49.5 + 4.2 + 8.7)$ — and those combinations, not the measured conorms, decide when a member enters. One enumeration serves every band up to 211 Å^2, where 4τ reaches the next conorm: the widened closure has six members for $8.7 \leq \tau < 45.0$, the six members of the unperturbed cell at the same integer coordinates; seven at 45.1; nine at 50; fourteen at 60; sixteen from 62.5.[z45] The members entering at 45.0 carry the near-orthorhombic twofolds, so a member's depth is the band at which the pseudo-symmetry it carries becomes visible, and its symmetries' prices say how far the measurement is from it.

Table 8. *The filter on the measured worked cell. Each row is a member of the idealised lattice's closure, named by a word in the flips of Table 1 from the reduced cell e; the six numbers are its conorms under the measured metric tensor, slots da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc, in Å²; "enters at" is its depth. At $\tau = 43.2$ the six members above the line are kept.*

word	*da*	*db*	*dc*	*ab*	*ac*	*bc*	enters at
e	49.5	1588.9	2444.7	4.2	847.5	4.5	0
ab	851.7	1593.1	2440.6	−4.2	53.7	8.7	4.2
bc	45.0	8.7	2449.3	1593.4	852.0	−4.5	4.5
ab.bc.db	2453.8	−4.5	847.5	1606.3	57.9	−4.2	4.5
ab.bc	842.9	4.5	2449.3	1601.8	62.5	−8.7	8.7
bc.db	2458.0	−8.7	53.7	1602.1	843.3	4.2	8.7
da	−49.5	2494.3	1638.4	53.7	897.0	−45.0	49.5
da.ab.bc	942.0	−45.0	1593.4	2556.7	12.9	−8.7	45.0
da.ab.ac	−49.5	2543.8	1588.9	954.9	−4.2	12.9	49.5
da.ab	950.7	2548.0	1584.7	−53.7	4.2	8.7	53.7
ab.ac	49.5	1539.3	2494.3	905.4	−53.7	62.5	53.7
bc.db.dc	45.0	2511.7	−53.7	1548.4	897.0	57.9	53.7
ab.ac.bc.ac	1610.5	959.1	2565.5	−4.2	−8.7	−53.7	53.7
da.ab.bc.ac	2569.6	−57.9	1606.3	954.9	−12.9	4.2	57.9
ab.ac.bc	−12.9	967.8	2556.7	1601.8	8.7	−62.5	62.5
ab.bc.ac	1664.2	−57.9	2511.7	905.4	−62.5	53.7	62.5

4.4. Reindexing from one reduced cell

The operators relating two settings of one lattice are one operator composed with the lattice symmetries, and each is an operator between a member of one closure and

a member of the other. On the measured worked pair at $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$, pairing the six members of the unperturbed cell with the six of the perturbed one, each pair in its best relative order, gives twelve pairs at a price of $14.4\,\text{Å}^2$ and nothing else below $1378\,\text{Å}^2$. The twelve pairs are four distinct operators, the $2/m$ coset, at a price equal to the perturbation: every member pairs with its own image and with the images under the symmetries, and several pairs give the same operator. At $\tau = 60\,\text{Å}^2$ the members carrying the near-orthorhombic symmetry are present: fourteen members give the same twelve pairs at 14.4, ten pairs at 150.7, all through the new members, and nothing below $992\,\text{Å}^2$.[z39] The band decides which pseudo-symmetries are offered.

A new cell needs no closure of its own. For fifteen references near orthorhombic, cubic, plate, monoclinic and hexagonal corners, each with twelve new cells carrying a random metric error of declared size and a random reindexing, the new cell's single reduced superbase was always a member of the reference's widened closure at the correct integer coordinates, and the true operator was always among the candidates: 180 of 180, with the band set from the declared error as in Appendix B.[z47]

Completeness of the stored set matters. A new cell constructed so that its only reduced superbase is a difference-wall member of an orthorhombic corner was matched against two stored sets of the reference. The set built as in Section 3.4 offers candidates at 7.83, 8.01 and $8.84\,\text{Å}^2$, each with its negative; the set built by idealising only at τ offers the first two and has lost the third, which is $\pm\mathbf{I}$, the true operator.[z46] The best candidate is still found, through a pseudo-symmetry, but the reported coset is incomplete.

The band that makes the true operator one of the candidates can be stated in advance, under a hypothesis on the error expressed in the reference frame. If the new cell's metric tensor, carried to the reference frame by the true operator, is within η of the reference's, if $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$ for the band below, and V is the sum of the squared lengths

of the new cell's three reduced vectors, then the band $\tau = \sqrt{2}\,\eta\,V/(\lambda_{\min} - \eta)$, with $\lambda_{\min}$ the smallest eigenvalue of the reference metric tensor, suffices (Proposition 3, Appendix A); the frame-free bound of Appendix B gives a version that does not refer to the operator. The guarantee held in all 180 cases but is conservative, with median 13η against a band near 3η that was in fact enough.[z47]

4.5. Measured cells from powder indexing

Oishi-Tomiyasu (2012, 2024) gives an error-stable Bravais-lattice determination for a measured cell, with a proof of completeness under a bound on the error, and distributes seven measured primitive cells from powder indexing with her program's output: for each Bravais type, the cell of that type nearest to the input and its distance. The closure gives the same information without a search over types. Table 9 treats each of the seven cells by Section 3.4 at the largest band the theorem allows, $\tau = \lambda_1/32$, and prices every operator out of the reduced cell in the closure of the idealised lattice; the price at which the number of operators reaches the order of a holohedry is the band at which that symmetry is offered.[z51] In all seven cases the band idealises the walls of the type the sample was indexed as, and the type's holohedry is reached in the price ladder at a price of the same size as the program's distance, between 0.4 and 2.5 times it, with the same ordering of types: for the alumina sample, $\bar{3}m$ at $1.7\,\text{Å}^2$ against the program's 1.9 and $m\bar{3}m$ at 9.2 against 9.6. The two measures differ in definition — a distance to the nearest lattice of a type against the residual of the operators that generate the type — so the numbers agree in order and size, not in value. Her test set of 4738 cells from a private database is not distributed; the seven cells are what is public.

Table 9. *The seven sample cells of BLDConograph (Oishi-Tomiyasu, 2024) by the closure: Bravais type and name as distributed; members of the idealised closure at $\tau = \lambda_1/32$; the price in $Å^2$ at which the number of operators out of the reduced cell reaches the order of the type's holohedry, and of the next holohedry up where one is reached; the program's minimal distance to a cell of that type.*[z51]

type	sample	members	price, type	price, next	distance
tI	HERMES_Sr327_250K	2	0.77	132.6	0.57
tP	1339prbasrcuo_bs1	16	0.10	26.0	0.056
cI	sample3	1	2.98	–	2.07
cF	CeO2_matsushita	3	0.11	–	0.084
hP	M402-pf-119673	6	22.5	196.1	20.5
mC	Acrinol-B-D8CuKa1	1	0.96	86.2	0.72
hR	Alumina676	3	1.69	9.18	1.93

5. Discussion

Relation to earlier work. The ingredients are classical. Selling (1874) and Delone (1933) introduced the reduction and the sorts; Conway & Sloane (1992) the conorm language and the identity used in Appendix A; Kurlin (2026) the finiteness and enumeration of obtuse superbases; Andrews, Bernstein and Sauter the S^6 formalism in which the flips are the boundary transformations and distances are measured across them (Andrews *et al.*, 2019; Andrews & Bernstein, 2023). Delone obtained his sorts from patterns of zeros and equalities, so Section 4.2 is a confirmation, not a discovery. Closest in aim is Oishi-Tomiyasu's error-stable Bravais-lattice determination (2012, 2024): a bound on the error under which a finite list of basis transforms is provably enough, which is the role $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$ plays here; she also names the failure that the hidden members of Section 4.3 resolve, a noisy cell that is nearly reduced while the true cell is not reduced in the same basis, and counts 336 transforms for a nearly face-centred cubic metric under Buerger reduction, where the closure has sixteen members. What is added here is: the accounting of Table 4, which separates the symmetries visible in a reduced cell from those that are operators to other cells and shows that symmetries never cross between cell shapes; the widened closure with its uniqueness and union characterisation; the

idealisation at 4τ with its completeness theorem and the demonstration that walks from the measured cell are incomplete; and the reindexing guarantee from one reduced cell. In the language of algebra the closure is a groupoid — objects, invertible arrows, consistent composition (Brandt, 1927; Brown, 2006) — and the symmetries form the action groupoid of the point group on the members; nothing beyond the definitions is used.

Where reindexing has been hard. The closure says in advance where two correct descriptions of one lattice can disagree. Within one sort it is the shapes of Table 6: each is a reduced cell of the lattice that a Selling reduction can return, and that a Niggli reduction with a tolerance (Grosse-Kunstleve *et al.*, 2004) can return when a near-zero decides the other way; no symmetry relates two of them, and a comparison that applies only the symmetries of the cell it holds cannot reconcile them. The monoclinic c versus $a + c$ choice is the oldest instance; the table shows it to be one of three, and Table 5 shows the textbook lattice conditions themselves — $a = c$ for a C-centred orthorhombic lattice hiding in a monoclinic cell, $c/a = \sqrt{2}$, $b = \sqrt{3}\,a$ — to be single linear conditions on conorms, the monoclinic ones carried one per cell choice, and shows that primitive orthorhombic, tetragonal and cubic lattices carry the same kind of alternative, each a monoclinic-looking cell that becomes the reported cell when the orthogonal walls are not recognised. Across sorts it is the walls: a measured cell within τ of a wall idealises into a sort with more members, and each member that enters at a depth below τ carries, in the monoclinic example, the pseudo-twofold whose price is the perturbation. The widened closure holds both kinds of alternative at once, with a depth for each, so, under the condition of Theorem 2, a reindexing is a lookup in a finite table rather than a search whose completeness depends on the cell it started from; the cells reported by two programs, or two data sets, are compared by reducing each once and pairing against the stored members, and the operator found is correct

up to the symmetries and pseudo-symmetries priced within the band. The instability of the Niggli cell (Gruber, 1973; Andrews & Bernstein, 1988) is the same phenomenon seen from the Niggli side: in the benchmark the measured cell's Niggli cell is a different cell from the reference's in 45 of 780 cases, nearly all at the body-centred orthorhombic boundary sort O3 and the lattices one condition away from it, and at the C-centred monoclinic boundary, where a Niggli angle passes through 90° or a special condition ties; the two Niggli cells are two shapes of one closure, a conventional cell derived from one through its lattice character is not derived from the other, and the operator between them is a flip, not a symmetry. The one open edge is the strongly anisotropic cell at low angular precision, where the widened set outgrows any single closure and the brute-force window takes over.

What is proved and what is checked. Proved in Appendix A, from Kurlin's results and two integer constants obtained by exhaustive enumeration, are: the uniqueness and union characterisation of the widened closure; the completeness of idealise–enumerate–filter when $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$; the generation of the closure by flips and swaps; and the reindexing guarantee. The nesting of partial idealisations (Lemma A6) rests on a finite verification over Kurlin's lists and is a check rather than a proof. Exhaustive but on generic lattices with random values, hence computations rather than proofs, are the identification of the 24 sorts and the counts of Table 4; exact integer arithmetic would close that gap. Kurlin's finiteness and his counts 1, 2, 3, 6, 16 are cited from a manuscript; the counts are reproduced here by brute force for every sort, so Appendix A depends on the manuscript only for finiteness. Checked in every case tested but not proved are that idealising at 2τ suffices, that a band per slot recovers anisotropic cells whenever the idealised lattice exists, that the true operator is found at the band set from the error rather than only at the conservative guarantee, and that the operators accepted within a band are exactly one operator composed with the idealised lattice's symme-

tries priced within it.

The frame. Statements about the widened closure are in terms of τ, a band on conorms, and need no frame. Converting an error on the metric tensor into τ does, because the Frobenius norm of an error depends on the basis. Appendix B gives the exact relation between a metric error and each conorm shift, the worst-case factors by zero pattern (up to $2\sqrt{3}$ in some cubic frames, so that $\tau = 3\eta$ is not a worst-case guarantee everywhere), a frame-free bound and the covariance route.

Implementation. The procedure of Section 3.4 replaces the band-limited walk previously used in the `agentsg` library, which Table 7 shows to be incomplete; the checks of Appendix C implement the procedure directly. The places where the closure predicts trouble — the shapes of Table 6, lattices a small distance from a condition of Table 5, cells whose only reduced superbase is a hidden member, anisotropic cells, the boundary sorts — are collected as a benchmark of 780 measured cells with their true operators (`manuscript/benchmark`); on it a symmetry-only reindexing proposes the true operator in 54% of the cases, the exact closure in 96%, a walk at τ in 97% with an incomplete set on every hidden case, and the procedure of Section 3.4 in every case within its hypothesis.

6. Conclusions

The Selling closure of a lattice contains, in one finite and complete set, every symmetry and every operator between alternative reduced cells, and a single reduced cell shows only the symmetries that relabel it. Its members and operators are fixed by the zero pattern and its symmetries by the Delone sort. For a measured cell, near-congruence within a band is decided by the widened closure, which is unique, equals the union of the exact closures of the lattices within the band of each member, and is computed completely, when the shortest lattice vector satisfies $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$, by idealising at 4τ,

enumerating and filtering. Reindexing a new cell onto a reference then reads one operator from that set, from a single reduced cell of the new cell, with a guarantee that the true operator is among those read. The alternative cells that have made reindexing uncertain — the monoclinic cell choices, the monoclinic-looking cells of orthogonal lattices, the unstable reduced cells of triclinic and boundary lattices, and the pseudo-symmetric cells near a wall — are the shapes and the shallow members of one closure, enumerated with their depths; the classical lattice conditions are the codimension-one specialisations between closures, 37 in all, each a conorm vanishing or two conorms becoming equal; the condition under which the enumeration is complete is a ratio of lengths, independent of the scale of the cell, and when it fails, as for strongly anisotropic cells at low precision, the failure of the condition is seen before any operator is proposed.

Appendix A
Proofs

Terms. Write a lattice vector in any basis, $x = n_1 v_1 + n_2 v_2 + n_3 v_3$ with integer n_i, and record whether each coordinate is even or odd. This sorts the lattice into eight *parity classes*; two vectors are in the same class exactly when their difference is twice a lattice vector, so the classes do not depend on the basis (the classes of $\Lambda/2\Lambda$). One class is the doubled vectors; the other seven are used here. A *partial sum* of a superbase is the sum of some of its four vectors; since the four add to zero, there are seven partial sums up to sign, one in each of the seven classes, and for the monoclinic superbase $(-a-b-c, a, b, c)$ they are a, b, c, $a+b$, $a+c$, $b+c$ and $a+b+c$. The fact used (Conway & Sloane, 1992; Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 2.4, 2.7 and A.1) is that a superbase is obtuse exactly when each of its partial sums is a shortest vector of

its parity class. The *excess* $e_c(F) = |v_c(F)|^2 - \mu_c$ of a superbase F in class c is the squared length of its partial sum $v_c(F)$ in that class minus the squared length μ_c of the shortest vector of the class; an obtuse superbase has zero excess in every class. A partial sum is written $w = \sum s_i v_i$ with $s \in \{0,1\}^4$ marking which vectors it adds; a vector of the same parity class has coordinates $s + 2k$ with k integer. Every lattice vector $x = \sum c_i v_i$ satisfies Selling's identity

$$|x|^2 = \sum_{i<j} p_{ij}\,(c_i - c_j)^2, \tag{3}$$

whatever the signs of the conorms, because the four vectors sum to zero. For a superbase F and two metrics, $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}')$ is the largest change among F's six conorms.

Proposition 1. $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F : F \in \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{G}')$ for some $\mathbf{G}'$ with $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}') \le \tau\}$. *Proof.* ($\supseteq$) If F is obtuse for $\mathbf{G}'$ and $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}') \le \tau$, every conorm of F under $\mathbf{G}$ is at least $-\tau$. ($\subseteq$) If $F \in \mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$, the metric whose conorms in the frame of F are $\max(p_{ij}, 0)$ exceeds $\mathbf{G}$ by a positive semidefinite term, so it is positive definite; F is obtuse for it, at δ_F equal to the depth of F. Each negative conorm must move at least to zero, so no nearer metric makes F obtuse. □

Lemma A1 (class excess identity). Let F be any superbase, $w = \sum s_i v_i$ a partial sum and w' a vector of its parity class with coordinates $s + 2k$. Then $|w|^2 - |w'|^2 = -4 \sum p_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, with $\gamma_{ij} = \Delta k(\Delta k + d)$, $\Delta k = k_i - k_j$, $d = s_i - s_j$; each γ_{ij} is a non-negative integer, zero exactly when $\Delta k \in \{0, -d\}$. *Proof.* Equation (3), $(d + 2\Delta k)^2 - d^2 = 4\Delta k(\Delta k + d)$, and $t(t + d) \ge 0$ for integers t and $d \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$.

Lemma A2 (class gap). Let Λ^* be obtained from F_0 by setting its conorms $\le \theta$ to zero, be positive definite, and let m^* be the smallest conorm of F_0 above θ. A superbase not obtuse for Λ^* has $e_c \ge 4m^*$ in some class. *Proof.* In the frame of F_0, with w the partial sum of F_0 in class c — a shortest vector of its class for $\mathbf{G}$ and for Λ^* — Lemma A1 gives $e_c(F) = 4 \sum p^0_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, a sum of non-negative terms, and the excess for Λ^* is the same sum over the slots above θ. If those terms vanish in all seven

classes, every partial sum of F is a shortest vector of its class for Λ^* and F is obtuse for it; otherwise some $\gamma_{ij} \geq 1$ multiplies a $p^0_{ij} \geq m^*$.

Lemma A3 (small excess in the band). If $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$ and every conorm of F is at least $-\tau$, then $e_c(F) \leq 16\tau$ in every class. *Proof.* Call a slot large if $p_{ij} > 8\tau$, and let N be the negative slots. The large slots connect the four vectors, since otherwise a split crossed only by slots with $p_{ij} \leq 8\tau$ has a partial sum of squared length at most $32\tau < \lambda_1$. With w' a shortest vector of the class, Lemma A1 in the frame of F gives $0 \leq e_c(F) = 4\sum_N |p_{ij}|\gamma_{ij} - 4\sum_{p_{ij}>0} p_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, so $\sum_{\text{large}} p\gamma \leq \tau \sum_N \gamma$. If a large γ were positive, Lemma A4(ii) would give $8\tau \sum_{\text{large}} \gamma < \tau \sum_N \gamma \leq 8\tau \sum_{\text{large}} \gamma$; so the large γ vanish, and Lemma A4(i) gives $e_c \leq 4\tau \cdot 4$.

Lemma A4 (two constants on four points). Let L be a set of slots connecting the four vectors and N disjoint from L. (i) If $\gamma_{ij} = 0$ on L, then $\sum_N \gamma_{ij} \leq 4$. (ii) $\sum_N \gamma_{ij} \leq 8\sum_L \gamma_{ij}$. Both are attained. *Proof.* In (i) $|\Delta k| \leq 1$ on L, so with $k_0 = 0$ all $|k_i| \leq 3$, and the maximum is a finite enumeration over the 38 connected slot sets, the sets N and the 14 partial sums. In (ii) the ratio is enumerated for $|k_i| \leq 15$; beyond, $Q = \sum_L \Delta k^2 > 75$, and $\sum_N \gamma \leq \rho Q + \sqrt{|N|\rho Q}$, $\sum_L \gamma \geq Q - \sqrt{|L|Q}$, with $\rho \leq 3 + 2\sqrt{2}$ the largest generalised eigenvalue of $\sum_N \Delta k^2$ against $\sum_L \Delta k^2$, keep it below 8 for every pattern. Equality in (ii): $L = \{01, 02, 13\}$, $N = \{03, 12, 23\}$, $s = (0, 0, 1, 1)$.[z44]

Theorem 2. Let F_0 be obtuse for $\mathbf{G}$, $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$, and Λ^* obtained by setting every conorm of F_0 that is at most 4τ to zero. Then Λ^* is positive definite and $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F \in \mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*) : p_{ij}(F; \mathbf{G}) \geq -\tau\}$. *Proof.* If the slots of F_0 above 4τ did not connect the four vectors, some partial sum would have squared length at most $16\tau < \lambda_1$. The inclusion $\supseteq$ is the definition. For $F \in \mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$, Lemma A3 gives $e_c(F) \leq 16\tau$ in every class; the smallest surviving conorm exceeds 4τ, so Lemma A2 makes F obtuse for Λ^*. □

Corollary 2a (operator form). Under the hypotheses of Theorem 2, let $\mathbf{W}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{W}_m$

be the integer changes of basis from F_0 to the members of $\mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*)$. Then $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F_0\mathbf{W}_k : \ p_{ij}(F_0\mathbf{W}_k;\mathbf{G}) \geq -\tau \text{ for all } ij\}$. *Proof.* The members of $\mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*)$ are the superbases $F_0\mathbf{W}_k$; the $\mathbf{W}_k$ are integer matrices independent of the metric, so the same superbases read with $\mathbf{G}$ are the right-hand side of Theorem 2. □

Lemma A5 (generation). Every operator between members of the closure, and every symmetry, is a sequence of flips at zero conorms followed by a swap. *Proof.* The members are reached from F_0 by flips at zero conorms (Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5), so flips and swaps connect all members. A symmetry maps F_0 to an obtuse superbase, which is a member; as a matrix it is the flip path from F_0 to that member followed by a swap.

Lemma A6 (nesting). If $Z' \subseteq Z$ are sets of conorms of F_0 set to zero, every member of the closure for Z' is a member of the closure for Z. *Proof.* By Kurlin's enumeration (2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5) the conorms of every member of the closure of a lattice are non-negative integer combinations of the non-zero conorms of its reduced superbase; the combinations are the same for every lattice with that zero pattern and are reproduced by the enumerations in [z46]. Setting further free conorms to zero keeps every such combination non-negative, so a member for Z' remains obtuse for Z.

Lemma A7 (sorts as closed patterns of equalities). Fix a zero pattern Z and let Π_Z be the permutations of the six conorm slots produced by the members of the closure under all swaps that keep the zeros in place. A lattice with zero pattern Z and a given pattern P of equal conorms has exactly the symmetries in Π_Z that preserve each class of P. *Proof.* A symmetry maps F_0 to a member with the same conorm vector, so it is an element of Π_Z that fixes the values; the members are complete by Kurlin's theorem, so no symmetry is missed. A permutation fixes a vector of values exactly when it preserves each class of equal values. Hence the pattern of equalities of a generic lattice of a sort is the orbit partition of its symmetry group, and every such

closed pattern is the pattern of the generic lattices of one sort.

Proposition 3 (reindexing guarantee). Let $\mathbf{G}'_N$ be the new cell's metric written in the reference frame, $\|\mathbf{G}'_N - \mathbf{G}_R\|_F \le \eta < \lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R)$, let F_N be its reduced superbase with basis vectors of summed squared length V, and let $\tau \ge \sqrt{2}\,\eta\,V/(\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R) - \eta)$ with $\lambda_1(\mathbf{G}_R) > 32\tau$. Then F_N, with its true integer coefficients in the reference frame, is a member of $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}_R)$, the procedure of Section 3.4 produces it, and pairing it with the new cell's reduced superbase proposes the true operator. *Proof.* Let u_i be the coordinates of F_N's basis vectors in the reference frame and $\Delta = \mathbf{G}'_N - \mathbf{G}_R$. Then $u_i^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{G}'_N u_i \ge (\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R) - \eta)|u_i|^2$, so $\sum |u_i|^2 \le V/(\lambda_{\min} - \eta)$. In F_N's own frame the error is $U\Delta U^{\mathsf{T}}$, of Frobenius norm at most $\sum |u_i|^2\,\eta$, and in its own frame every conorm shift is at most $\sqrt{2}$ times that norm (Appendix B). The conorms of F_N under $\mathbf{G}'_N$ are non-negative, so under $\mathbf{G}_R$ they are at least $-\tau$, and Theorem 2 applies. The proposed operator for the pair is the change of basis between the two copies of F_N, which is the true one. □

Appendix B
From a metric error to a band

A conorm is linear in the metric, so a metric error $\Delta\mathbf{G}$ shifts the conorm of a member with coordinate vectors u_i, u_j by exactly $-u_i^{\mathsf{T}}\Delta\mathbf{G}\,u_j$; by Cauchy–Schwarz in the Frobenius product the shift is at most $c_{ij}\eta$, with $c_{ij} = \|\operatorname{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})\|_F = [\frac{1}{2}(|u_i|^2|u_j|^2 + (u_i \cdot u_j)^2)]^{1/2}$, and an error along $\operatorname{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})$ attains it. Every exact member of a stored closure survives in the widened closure of the measurement, for every error of norm η, exactly when τ is at least the coverage bound $\tau_{\mathrm{cov}} = \max(c_{ij}\eta - p_{ij})$, read off the stored closure.[z36] For the worked cells $\eta = 14.4\,\text{Å}^2$ and $\tau = 3\eta = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$. Member vectors are not confined to $\{-1, 0, 1\}$; on two and three walls they carry entries up to 3. On walls the largest constant is $\sqrt{2}$ with one zero, $\sqrt{5}$ with two, and

with three zeros $2\sqrt{3}$ in six of the sixteen labelled cuboid frames — those whose zeros form a path with d at an interior vertex — and at most $\sqrt{5}$ otherwise; on positive slots it is at most 7.2. In a $2\sqrt{3}$ frame an adversarial error of norm η drives a member to $-3.46\,\eta$, so $\tau = 3\eta$ is not a worst-case guarantee in every frame.[z36] In a member's own frame the member is the standard superbase, whose largest constant is $\sqrt{2}$, so $\tau = \sqrt{2}\,\eta^*$ with η^* the largest error norm over the members' own frames covers every member; it is uniform but loose, 2.8 times the reduced-frame η in the median case and up to 17 times.[z36] With a covariance Σ for the metric, the variance of each member conorm is the quadratic form of Σ on $\mathrm{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})$, exact in any frame, and the band can be set slot by slot.

Appendix C
Computational checks

Each mark [z*nn*] refers to `manuscript/appendix_z/test_znn_*.py` in the `agentsg` repository.

mark	what is checked
z36	shift identity; constants by zero pattern and frame; adversarial loss at 3η; frame-free bound
z39	measured worked pair: widened closure by definition; candidate operators at $\tau =$ 43.2 and 60
z44	constants 4 and 8; class gap and excess; Theorem 2 against brute force; grey zone; worked cell
z45	reduction endpoints and restarts; walks on the measured metric; the worked filter table
z46	the monoclinic example; closures of the 24 sorts; shapes = orbits; twofolds generate; coset completeness; difference-wall members; 2τ; nesting
z47	reindexing under a declared error: membership, true operator, guarantee
z48	the 24 Delone sorts reproduced from six zero patterns
z49	bands per slot on needles and plates: exactness, the plate floor, detection of the failed hypothesis; the cell shapes of Table 6
z50	the 37 codimension-one specialisations between sorts and the shapes that carry them (Table 5)
z51	the seven BLDConograph sample cells: idealised closure, price ladder, comparison with the program's distances (Table 9)

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Synopsis

The set of all Selling-reduced cells of a lattice, with the integer matrices between them, holds the lattice symmetry and every alternative choice of reduced cell in one complete set. For a measured cell the set is recovered exactly by setting every small conorm to zero, enumerating and filtering, and reindexing reads one matrix from it.